

‘We’re hoping to move away from this overcorrection.’

KELLY TURLEY, *Massachusetts Coalition for the Homeless* associate director

At shelters, unused beds costing the state

New rules cut steep outlays but lock out some needing refuge

By **Stephanie Ebbert** and **Deirdre Fernandes**

GLOBE STAFF

Amid mounting safety concerns and costs that ballooned to more than \$1 billion a year, Governor Maura Healey last year shuttered all the hotels serving as shelters for homeless families and tightened eligibility for the remaining sites.

The changes reined in runaway spending but disqualified so many that taxpayers are now paying for thousands

of empty beds — even as some families with children are denied shelter.

Massachusetts is still spending millions of dollars to provide shelter for nearly 4,000 families, but there were only 1,488 families in the system by the end of December, a vacancy rate of more than 60 percent, according to the Executive Office of Housing and Livable Communities.

The state would not say now much the empty beds cost, but a Globe analysis suggests it could be in the millions. In total, over the past six months, Massachusetts spent at least \$217 million on the shelter system, far less than in recent years.

SHELTERS, Page A16



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Sara Kelly (pictured at a prenatal appointment at Mass. General) fears her baby could be taken from her if she is unable to secure stable housing.

In a town with 23,553 registered voters — **10,620** enrolled as Democrats and **617** Republican, the sitting mayor was reelected by only **76 votes.**

In bluest of places, ugly tone tints city politics

Northampton riven by left-on-left animosity

By **Brooke Hauser**

GLOBE STAFF

NORTHAMPTON — Mayor Gina-Louise Sciarra, whose progressive city is known for its crunchy vibes and rainbow crosswalks, recently helped lead its “No Kings” rally. She called President Trump “a mad authoritarian” and pleaded for unity among constituents because, she said, he “feeds on division.”

But blasting the president wasn’t enough to stop her fiercest critics from framing her as an elitist waging “war on poor people” and comparing *her* to Trump for what they see as her iron-fisted control over city resources.

“Our mayor can’t invade other countries, but she does the absolute worst she can do to our community every day,” Quaverly H. Rothenberg, a former city councilor who has styled herself as the mayor’s archnemesis, told her social-media followers. “I like to call them her Qult,” posted a commenter on Reddit.

The personal has always been political in this city of around 31,000, but rarely has local politics seemed so *intensely* personal. Long-simmering tensions over the school budget came to a head earlier this month, when the mayor’s husband, Bill Scher, lost his temper while confronting one of his wife’s detractors, a School Committee member named Michael

NORTHAMPTON, Page A13

Bucking to be primary provider in medicine

Dispensing care in community paying for BILH

By **Jessica Bartlett**

GLOBE STAFF

Sometimes, it pays to be number two.

Beth Israel Lahey Health has long been the state’s second-largest hospital system, the second biggest employer, the second most fill-in-the-blank. When compared to Mass General Brigham, owner of Massachusetts’ two biggest hospitals, Beth Israel’s place in the pecking order was always clear.

But Mass General Brigham has faced a number of challenges in recent years, from losing its relationship with Dana-Farber Cancer Institute to a unionization campaign by its primary care physicians amid discontent among wide swaths of its doctors. In many ways, Beth Israel has benefited from its competitor’s issues: It’s struck its own collaboration with the renowned Dana-Farber and has recruited dozens of primary care clinicians — one-third of whom came from MGB alone in the last year.

Yet Beth Israel Lahey Health hasn’t just sat back and passively gained ground. The system and its leader, Dr. Kevin Tabb, had a strategic vision for the long haul that, despite challenges, seems to

BETH ISRAEL, Page A14



MYERS PARK HIGH SCHOOL, 2018-19

After transferring, Maye completed 72 percent of his passes for 3,512 yards and 50 touchdowns in his junior year.

UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA, 2021-23

Flipped from Alabama to UNC, where as a redshirt freshman he was ACC Player of the Year with 4,321 passing yards and 38 touchdowns.

PATRIOTS, DRAFTED 2024

Started 12 games as a rookie, threw 15 touchdown passes and named to the Pro Bowl. MVP candidate in his second year.

SOURCES: New England Patriots, NFL

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In a family of achievers he wasn’t a star, at first. Then came the deep downfield passes.

BY NICOLE YANG | GLOBE STAFF

CHARLOTTE, N.C. In between the student center of Myers Park High School and Gus Purcell Stadium, there’s a parking lot with about 100 spaces. For more than a decade, those spots would be fairly easy to snag on Friday nights for the school’s home football games.

Scott Chadwick, Myers Park’s football coach for seven seasons, estimates the program’s booster club sold only half of its season-long parking passes during his first year in 2014. The numbers continued to grow gradually as the team’s performance improved.

Then came Drake Maye. “Those Friday nights at Myers Park were really, really special,” Chadwick said. “He just took us to a whole different level.” Maye, already 6 feet 3 inches at 16 years old and still years away from the cusp of reaching the Super Bowl, transferred to Myers Park ahead of his sophomore season in 2018 and almost immediately became a sensation. The next year, those parking passes sold out within 20 minutes.

The morning they went on sale, people staked out the front yard of the booster club’s membership coordinator in fear

MAYE, Page C8



JAIDA GREY EAGLE/BLOOMBERG

Federal agents kill man amid protests in Minneapolis

The fatal shooting prompted more clashes with law enforcement and renewed demands that the Trump administration end its immigration crackdown in the state. **A11.**

A winter visit to Paris was almost perfect, except for the weather. **SundayTravel, N1.**

More pet owners are opting for euthanasia at home, not at the vet’s. It’s good for the animals and the humans. **Ideas, K1.**

Snow business

Sunday: Snow. High: 24-29. Low: 20-25.
Monday: More snow. Complete report, **A24.**
Deaths, **A18-22.**

VOL. 309, NO. 25

Suggested retail price \$6.00



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